**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**
(a) 3 only (b) 1 and 3 (c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2

**Ans. (a) :** The United Nations Credentials Committee is a committee of the United Nations General Assembly. Hence 1st statement is incorrect.
A Credentials Committee is appointed at the beginning of each regular session (intensively from September to December) of the General Assembly. Hence 2nd statement is also incorrect.
The Committee reports to the Assembly on the credentials of representatives. The Committee is mandated to examine the credentials of representatives of Member States and to report to the General Assembly thereon (Rule 28 of the Rules of Procedure of the General Assembly). Therefore 3rd statement is correct.

**77. Which one of the following statements best describes the 'Polar Code'?**
(a) It is the international code of safety for ships operating in polar waters.
(b) It is the agreement of the countries around the North Pole regarding the demarcation of their territories in the polar region.
(c) It is a set of norms to be followed by the countries whose scientists undertake research studies in the North Pole and South Pole.
(d) It is a trade and security agreement of the member countries of the Arctic Council.

**Ans. (a) :** Polar Code is the International code of safety for ships operating in polar waters that covers the full range of design, construction, equipment, operational, training, search and rescue and environmental protection matters relevant to ships operating in the inhospitable waters surrounding the two poles.

**78. With reference to the United Nations General Assembly, consider the following statements:**
1. The UN General Assembly can grant observer status to the non-member States.
2. Inter-governmental organisations can seek observer status in the UN General Assembly.
3. Permanent Observers in the UN General Assembly can maintain missions at the UN headquarters.

**Which of the statements given above are correct ?**
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

**Ans. (d):** All the given statements are correct regarding the United Nations General Assembly i.e. The United Nations General Assembly may grant non-member states, international organizations and other entities Permanent Observer Status. However, The UN Charter and the General Assembly Rules of Procedure have no provisions related to granting permanent observer status and is based on practice only. Permanent Observers may participate in the sessions and workings of the General Assembly and maintain missions at the UN Headquarters.

**79. With reference to the "Tea Board" in India, consider the following statements:**
1. The Tea Board is a statutory body.
2. It is a regulatory body attached to the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare.
3. The Tea Board's Head Office is situated in Bengaluru.
4. The Board has overseas offices at Dubai and Moscow.

**Which of the statements given above are correct ?**
(a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 and 4 (c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

**Ans. (d):** The Tea Board of India is a statutory body set up under section 4 of the Tea Act, 1953 and constituted on 1st April 1954. Hence 1st statement is correct.
It is functions under the Ministry of Commerce and its Head Office is situated in Kolkata and not in Bengaluru. (Hence 2nd and 3rd statements are incorrect).
The Tea Board of India has overseas offices in Moscow, Dubai, Hamburg, London and New York. Hence 4th statement is correct.

**80. Which one of the following best describes the term "greenwashing"?**
(a) Conveying a false impression that a Company's products are eco-friendly and environmentally sound
(b) Non-inclusion of ecological/ environmental costs in the Annual Financial Statements of a country
(c) Ignoring the disastrous ecological consequences while undertaking infrastructure development
(d) Making mandatory provisions for environmental costs in a government project/ programme

**Ans. (a):** Greenwashing is the process of conveying a false impression or providing misleading information about how a company's products are more environmentally sound. Greenwashing is considered an unsubstantiated claim to deceive consumers into believing that a company's products are environmentally friendly.

**81. Consider the following statements:**
1. High clouds primarily reflect solar radiation and cool the surface of the Earth.
2. Low clouds have a high absorption of infrared radiation emanating from the Earth's surface and thus cause warming effect.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

**Ans. (d) :** High clouds are often thin and do not reflect very much. They let lots of the Sun's heat into it. They radiate less energy into space than the lower warmer clouds. Therefore, high clouds work to "trap" more energy than the low clouds. Statement (1) is incorrect.
Low clouds are often quite thick and reflect lots of sunlight back to space. Low clouds are excellent reflectors. But, they don't stop the longwave energy from escaping to space. Therefore, low clouds help to cool the Earth. Statement (2) is incorrect.

**82. Consider the following statements:**
1. Bidibidi is a large refugee settlement in north-western Kenya.
2. Some people who fled from South Sudan civil war live in Bidibidi.
3. Some people who fled from civil war in Somalia live in Dadaab refugee complex in Kenya.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only (c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

**Ans. (c) :** The Bidibidi Refugee Settlement is located in the West Nile Area of Uganda, and is home to over 270,000 South Sudanese refugees, the second largest refugee settlement in the world. Hence, statement 1 is not correct and statement 2 is correct.
The Dadaab refugee complex has a population of over 2 lakh registered refugees and asylum seekers. Dadaab refugee complex consists of three camps. The first camp was established in 1991, when refugees fleeing the civil war in Somalia started to cross the border into Kenya. So, statement 3 is correct.
Therefore, option (c) is the correct answer.

**83. Consider the following countries:**
1. Armenia 2. Azerbaijan 3. Croatia
4. Romania 5. Uzbekistan

**Which of the above are members of the Organization of Turkic States?**
(a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1 and 3 (c) 2 and 5 (d) 3, 4 and 5

**Ans. (c) :** The Organization of Turkic States, formerly called the Turkic Council or the Cooperation Council of Turkic Speaking States, is an international organization comprising prominent independent Turkic countries: Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Turkey and Uzbekistan. Therefore the correct answer is option (c).

**84. Consider the following statements:**
1. Gujarat has the largest solar park in India.
2. Kerala has a fully solar powered International Airport.
3. Goa has the largest floating solar photovoltaic project in India.

**Which of the statements given above is/are correct?**
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only (c) 1 and 3 (d) 3 only

**Ans. (b) :** India's Bhadla Solar Park in Rajasthan is the largest solar power park in the world. Hence, Statement (1) is incorrect.
Kerala's Cochin International Airport Ltd (CIAL) is the first airport in the world that would be running fully on solar power. Hence, Statement (2) is correct.
The 600 MW capacity floating solar project on Omkareshwar reservoir (in Madhya Pradesh) is not only India's but also the world's largest floating solar project so far. Statement 3 is incorrect.

**85. With reference to the United Nations Convention on the Law of Sea, consider the following statements:**
1. A coastal state has the right to establish the breadth of its territorial sea up to a limit not exceeding 12 nautical miles, measured from baseline determined in accordance with the convention.
2. Ships of all states, whether coastal or land-locked, enjoy the right of innocent passage through the territorial sea.
3. The Exclusive Economic Zone shall not extend beyond 200 nautical miles from the baseline from which the breadth of the territorial sea is measured.

**Which of the statements given above are correct?**
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1,2 and 3

**Ans. (d) :** According to Article 3 under section 2 of United nations conventions (UNCLOS) regarding the territorial limits of the sea, every state has the right to establish the breadth of its territorial sea up to a limit not exceeding 12 nautical miles, measured from baselines determined in accordance with this Convention. Hence, Statement 1 is correct.
According to Article 17 under section 3 of United nations conventions (UNCLOS), ships of all States, whether coastal or land-locked, enjoy the right of innocent passage through the territorial sea. Hence, Statement 2 is correct.
The 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) defines an Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ). It is an area that shall not extend beyond 200 nautical miles from the baselines. The EEZ is measured from the breadth of the territorial sea. Hence, Statement 3 is correct.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

**86. Which one of the following statements best reflects the issue with Senkaku Islands, sometimes mentioned in the news?**
(a) It is generally believed that they are artificial islands made by a country around South China Sea.
(b) China and Japan engage in maritime disputes over these islands in East China Sea.
(c) A permanent American military base has been set up there to help Taiwan to increase its defence capabilities.
(d) Though International Court of Justice declared them as no man's land, some South-East Asian countries claim them.

**Ans. (b) :** The Senkaku Islands are a group of uninhabited islands in the East China Sea. They are known in China as the Diaoyu Islands. The islands are the focus of a territorial dispute between Japan and China. China claims the discovery and ownership of the islands from the 14th century, while Japan maintained ownership of the islands from 1895 until its surrender at the end of World War II. Hence option (b) is the correct answer.

**87. Consider the following pairs:**

| Country | | Important reason for Being in the news recently |
|---|---|---|
| 1. Chad | - | Setting up of permanent military base by China |
| 2. Guinea | - | Suspension of Constitution and Government by military |
| 3. Lebanon | - | Severe and prolonged economic depression |
| 4. Tunisia | - | Suspension of Parliament by President |

**How many pairs given above are correctly matched?**
(a) Only one pair (b) Only two pairs
(c) Only three pairs (d) All four pairs

**Ans. (c) :** In 2020, President Idris Deby Itno was killed during fighting against rebels in northern Chad, he was succeeded by his son, Mahamat Idriss Deby Itno, as the head of a military junta. It was not in the news for setting up of permanent military base by China. So, pair (1) is not correctly matched.
Some US officials are reported to have warned that Beijing plans to establish a permanent military installation in Guinea. Recently, Guinea's military leaders have suspended the constitution and closed the country's borders. So, pair (2) is correctly matched.
Lebanon is enduring a severe and prolonged economic depression. According to the latest World Bank Lebanon Economic Monitor (LEM), the economic and financial crisis is likely to rank in the top 10, possibly top 3, most severe crises episodes globally since the mid-nineteenth century. So, pair (3) is correctly matched.
Tunisia's President Kais Saied has dissolved the country's parliament. So, pair (4) is correctly matched.